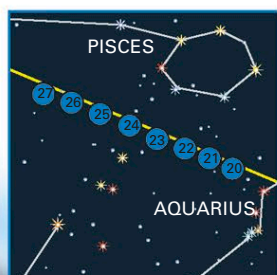




THE SMALL MAGELLANIC CLOUD

This small satellite galaxy (left) appears beside the globular cluster 47 Tucanae (right), which is in the foreground in our own galaxy.

NEPTUNE



SOUTHERN LATITUDES

THE STARS

Scorpius is low in the west, with Sagittarius and the densest regions of the Milky Way above it. The large northern Summer Triangle of Altair, Vega, and Deneb is visible in the northwest, while in the southwest, Alpha (α) and Beta (β) Centauri—Rigel Kentaurus (see p.252) and Hadar—are visible from latitude 20°S and farther south. The Square of Pegasus dominates the northeastern sky.

First-magnitude Fomalhaut (see p.253) in Piscis Austrinus is almost overhead, along with Capricornus and Aquarius. Achernar, the bright star at the end of the celestial river Eridanus, is high in the southeast, as is the Small Magellanic Cloud (see p.311). A group of constellations with exotic names, such as Phoenix, Tucana, Grus, and Pavo, is spread across the southern half of the sky.

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

Aquarius contains two famous planetary nebulae, although neither is particularly easy to find through small instruments. The Helix Nebula (see p.257), or NGC 7293, is the nearest planetary nebula to us. Its size means that its light is spread out over such a large area that clear skies are essential to glimpse it through binoculars or a low-power telescope. The Saturn Nebula, NGC 7009, is so named because, when seen through a large telescope, it appears to have rings like the planet Saturn. A small telescope shows the Saturn Nebula simply as a greenish disk.

Also in Aquarius is the globular cluster M2, which resembles a fuzzy star when seen through binoculars. To the north of this is another globular cluster that can be viewed through binoculars, M15 in Pegasus.

POSITIONS OF THE PLANETS

This chart shows the positions of the planets in September from 2020 to 2027. The planets are represented by colored dots, while the number inside each dot denotes the year. For all planets apart from Mercury, the dot indicates the planet's position on September 15. Mercury is shown only when it is at greatest elongation (see p.68)—for the specific date, refer to the table, left.

- | | | | |
|---------|---------|--------|---------|
| Mercury | Mars | Saturn | Neptune |
| Venus | Jupiter | Uranus | |

EXAMPLES

25 Jupiter's position on September 15, 2025

20 Saturn's position on September 15, 2020. The arrow indicates the planet is in retrograde motion (see p.68).

